55. What is/are the facility /facilities the beneficiaries can get from the services of Business Correspondent (Bank Saathi) in branchless areas ?

1. It enables the beneficiaries to draw their subsidies and social security benefits in their villages.
2. It enables the beneficiaries in the rural areas to make deposits and withdrawals.

Select the correct answer using the code below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): Business correspondents (BCs) are retail agents engaged by banks for providing banking services at locations other than a bank branch/ATM. BCs enable a bank to provide its limited range of banking services at a low cost. Hence they are instrumental in promoting financial inclusion.

56. In the context of Indian economy, which of the following is/are the purpose/purposes of 'Statutory Reserve Requirements'?

1. To enable the Central Bank to control the amount to advances the banks can create.
2. To make the people's deposits with banks safe and liquid.
3. To prevent the commercial banks from making excessive profits.
4. To force the banks to have sufficient vault cash to meet their day to day requirements.

Select the correct answer using the code below:

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (a): The statutory reserve requirements is a banking sector arrangement under which all banks have to keep a certain percentage of their total deposits in the form of liquidity. Its purpose is basically to curb the lending tendency of banks.

57. If the interest rate is decreased in an economy it, will -

(a) decrease the consumption expenditure in the economy
(b) increase the tax collection of the Government
(c) increase the investment expenditure in the economy
(d) increase the total savings in the economy

Ans. (c) : Decreased interest rates would ensure the availability of capital for investment expenditure. There is no relation between the interest rate and the Tax collection or Fiscal deficit of the government.

• Foreign Trade of India, Economic Organizations & Share Market

58. Which of the following organizations brings out the publication known as 'World Economic Outlook' ?

(a) The International Monetary Fund
(b) The United Nations Development Programme
(c) The World Economic Forum
(d) The World Bank

Ans. (a): The World Economic Outlook (WEO) database contains selected macroeconomic data series from the statistical appendix of the World Economic Outlook report prepared by IMF.

SCIENCE

• Biology

59. Lichens, which are capable of initiating ecological succession even on a bare rock, are actually a symbiotic association of -

(a) Algae and bacteria (b) Algae and fungi
(c) Bacteria and fungi (d) Fungi and mosses

Ans. (b): Lichen grows mainly on rock, ground, old walls and leaves and bark of trees. In fact, lichen, algae and fungi are symbiotic associations.

60. Which one of the following is the process involved in photosynthesis ?

(a) Potential energy is released to form free energy
(b) Free energy is converted into potential energy and stored.
(c) Food is oxidized to release carbon dioxide and water.
(d) Oxygen is taken, and carbon dioxide and water vapour are given out.

Ans. (b): Sunlight (free energy) is converted into carbohydrates (potential energy) using water and carbon dioxide, oxygen is released in the process.

61. Which of the following is/are correct regarding vegetative propagation of plants ?

1. Vegetative propagation produces clonal population.
2. Vegetative propagation helps in eliminating the virus.
3. Vegetative propagation can be practiced most of the year.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : The Second option is wrong because if the parent plant has a virus, then it will not be eliminated but further propagated.

62. Consider the following techniques/phenomena :

1. Budding and grafting in fruit plants
2. Cytoplasmic male sterility
3. Gene silencing

Which of the above is/are used to create transgenic crop?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) None

Ans. (b) : All three methods are related to transgenic crops directly or indirectly. The Cytoplasmic male sterility and Gene silencing are new technologies specifically developed for this purpose. So option (b) looks more appropriate.

• Medical Science , Zoology

63. Consider the following diseases :

1. Diphtheria 2. Chickenpox
3. Smallpox

Which of the above diseases has/have been eradicated in India ?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) None

Ans. (b): India was declared smallpox free in April 1977. In February 2000, India was declared a disease-free country by Guinea worm by the World Health Organization and on 27th March 2014 was granted the status of a polio-free country.

64. Consider the following :

1. Bats
2. Bears
3. Rodents

The phenomenon of hibernation can be observed in which of the above kinds of animals?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 1,2 and 3
(d) Hibernation cannot be obvserved in any of the above

Ans. (c) : Hibernation is a state of inactivity and metabolic depression in endotherms. There are several animals that hibernate-skunks, bees, snakes, and groundhogs , but bears and bats are the most well-known. Rodents also undergo hibernation.

65. In addition to fingerprint scanning, which of the following can be used in the biometric identification of a person?

1. Iris scanning 2. Retinal scanning
3. Voice recognition

State the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d) : Biometric verification is any means by which a person can be uniquely identified by evaluating one or more destining wishing biological traits. Unique identifiers, hand geometry, earlobe geometry, retina and iris patterns, voice waves, DNA and signatures.

66. Among the following organisms, which one does not belong to the class of other three?

(a) Crab (b) Mite
(c) Scorpion (d) Spider

Ans. (a) : Mite, scorpion and spider belong to the class Arachnida while crab belongs to class crustaceans.

67. Consider the following pairs

Vitamin		Deficiency disease
1. Vitamin C	:	Scurvy
2. Vitamin D	:	Rickets
3. Vitamin E	:	Night Blindness

Which of the pairs given above is / are correctly matched ?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) None

Ans. (a): Scurvy is the name of disease for vitamin C deficiency. Rickets is a skeletal disorder that's caused by a lack of vitamin D, calcium, or phosphate. Night blindness (in which it is difficult or impossible to see in relatively low light) is one of the clinical signs of vitamin A deficiency.

• Science and Technology

68. With reference to two non-conventional energy sources called 'coal bed methane ' and 'shale gas', consider the following statements :

1. Coal bed methane is the pure methane gas extracted from coal seams, while shale gas is a mixture of propane and butane only that can be extracted from fine-grained sedimentary rocks.
2. In India, abundant coal bed methane sources exist, but so far, no shale gas sources have been found.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d): Coal bed methane is a form of natural gas extracted from coal beds and contains very little heavier hydrocarbons propane or butane, while statement (1) is incorrect as coal bed methane is a form of natural gas extracted from coal beds and has butane and propane on hydrocarbons while shale gas carries methane. In India, shale reserves are three in Cambay, Assam-Arakan, Gondwana, Krishana- Godavari, Kaveri and Indo Gangetic plain, while coalbed methane is only available at Asansol in West Bengal, so statement (2) is also incorrect. Since both statements (1) and (2) are incorrect, so option (d) is right.

69. Which of the following is/are the example/ examples of chemical change ?

1. Crystallization of sodium chloride
2. Melting of ice
3. Souring of milk

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1,2 and 3 (d) None

Ans. (b): Chemical changes occur when a substance combines with another to form a new substance, called Chemical synthesis into two are more different substances. Crystallization of sodium chloride and melting of ice are examples of physical changes, while souring of milk is a chemical change.

70. Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched ?

Spacecraft	Purpose
1. Cassini-Huygens	Orbiting the Venus and transmitting data to the Earth
2. Messenger	Mapping and investigating the Mercury
3. Voyager 1 and 2	Exploring the outer solar system

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): Cassini Huygens is a spacecraft of NASA launched to probe into the mysteries of the planet Saturn. Messenger is NASA mission to mercury and Voyager 1 and 2 are meant for exploring outer space.